

“There was **never a question** in my mind that **I wanted to climb that mountain**, no matter what **other people** said.”

JUNKO Tabei on climbing Mount Everest, 1975

From the late 19th century, new technologies made exploration easier as journeys by train, plane, balloon, motorcycle, and car became possible. Marie Marvingt was not only a talented athlete but also a pioneer who, when refused permission to join the male-only Tour de France in 1908, waited until the race had finished and rode the route. In 1909 she became the first woman to pilot a balloon across the English Channel. The first black female pilot, Bessie Coleman, was inspired to fly by the stories of World War I pilots. Banned from US flying schools, she learned French and went to Paris in 1921 to gain her pilot's license.

Magazines such as *National Geographic*, film, and television galvanized others. The feats of underwater filmmaker Lotte Hass and Valentina Tereshkova (see pp. 258–259), the first woman in space in 1963, were televised. Today, the world still beckons women to explore. As adventurer Lois Pryce advises: “The only way to get ready for an adventure is to have one.”

► Marrying adventure

Osa and Martin Johnson thrilled the US public with their films and books of exotic adventure in East and Central Africa. This is the poster for the 1940 film based on Osa's autobiography *I Married Adventure*.



PROFILES

INTREPID EXPLORERS

Jeanne Baret (1740–1807) was the first woman to complete a voyage of circumnavigation. She joined Admiral Bougainville's 1766 expedition by cross-dressing and acting as assistant botanist to Philibert Commerçon (women were not allowed on French naval ships at the time and she flattened her chest with tightly bound linen). Her gender was discovered when the expedition reached Tahiti in 1768, when a Tahitian, Ahu-toru, suggested she was a transvestite. Baret then confessed she was a woman to Bougainville, but he allowed her to continue to travel as Commerçon's assistant.

Sacagawea (c. 1788–1812) was a Lemhi Shoshone tribeswoman who achieved more adventures than most minority women due to her linguistic skills. She acted as a guide, interpreter, mediator, and naturalist on the Lewis and Clark Expedition of the Louisiana Territory—a two-year mapping, scientific, and trading venture. She was the only woman to accompany the expedition.

Nellie Bly (1864–1922) was an American investigative journalist who traveled around the world in 72 days. Her journey was a successful rebut to her *New York World* editor who had argued that she would need a chaperone and many suitcases, and so would not succeed. Traveling by public transportation, Bly beat reporter Elizabeth Bisland who *Cosmopolitan* had sent to attempt the same feat in the other direction.

Clärenore Stinnes (1901–1990) was the first woman to circumnavigate the world by automobile, from 1927 to 1929. In an Adler Standard 6, this prize-winning racer and industrialist's daughter drove 29,000 miles (47,000 km) with Carl-Axel Söderström—whom she had met only two days earlier. They had two mechanics and a support truck.

Barbara Hillary (b. 1931) is the first African American woman to reach both Poles. She attained the North Pole in 2007, aged 76, and the South Pole in 2011. After surviving cancer twice this retired nurse set herself the goal of becoming the first black person to get to the Arctic and Antarctic extremes, raising over \$25,000.